Texaco Tanker Comms Flow

vSFG7 SkyEye · Caucasus (Day / Night) · Command 282.000 → Texaco 1-1 252.100 / Texaco 3-1 252.300 AM · SkyEye 823cf86, 20 Oct 2026

Tanker	Frequency	TACAN	Track
Texaco 1-1 · KC-130, port + starboard baskets	**252.100 AM** · Hornet COMM 2 CH 8	51Y TX1	13,000 ft, about 260 KIAS
Texaco 3-1 · KC-135 MPRS, port + starboard baskets	**252.300 AM** · Hornet COMM 2 CH 10	53Y TX3	24,000 ft, about 265 KIAS

The same calls work on both; the examples use Texaco 1-1 (on 3-1 say "Texaco 3" / "Texaco 3-1"). Calls follow the vSFG-7 AAQ Aerial Refueling Procedure: observation is always **port**, reform always **starboard**. Say your callsign, with its number, in every call. **Radio check** any time: "Texaco 1-1, Knight 1-1, comm check" → "loud and clear".

1. Command (282.000): find the tanker (optional)

Pilot	Command
"Command, Knight 1-1, **request tanker**" (or "say Texaco", "nearest tanker")	"Knight 1-1, Command, Texaco 1-1 bears 045 for 32, angels 13. **Contact Texaco one one on two five two point one.** Contact Texaco three one on two five two point three."

Switch to the tanker at about 20 DME. Flight safe on interflight first: "Flight, switches safe, noses cold."

2. Texaco (252.100 / 252.300): initial to checking out

Step	Pilot (SRS)	Texaco
Initial ~20 DME	"Texaco 1, Knight 1-1, flight of 2, 15 mile initial for **port observation** with intent to refuel"	"Knight 1-1, Texaco one one, cleared port observation, one three thousand, velocity two six zero. **How much do you request?**"
Give	"Knight 1-1, **request 5.0**" (or "five thousand pounds", "full")	"Knight 1-1, Texaco, you are cleared for five thousand pounds."
1 mile trail	"Texaco 1, Knight 1-1, flight of 2, **1 mile trail** for port observation"	"Knight 1-1, Texaco, continue port observation."
Observation	"Texaco 1, Knight 1-1, **established port observation**"	"Knight 1-1, Texaco, copy. **Port and starboard baskets open.**"
Basket	"Knight 1-3, **moving to starboard basket**"	"Knight 1-3, Texaco, cleared starboard basket." Taken: "standby, starboard basket occupied. Port basket open."
At the basket	"Knight 1-3, **established starboard basket**"	"Knight 1-3, Texaco, copy, call ready pre-contact." - then "ready pre-contact": "cleared contact starboard basket."
In DCS	AI comms menu: **Ready pre-contact**	DCS tanker: "Cleared contact" (or "Return pre-contact": a little closer and higher). Plug and take fuel.
Reform	"Knight 1-3, **satisfied, moving to starboard reform**" "Knight 1-3, **established starboard reform**"	"Knight 1-3, Texaco, cleared starboard reform." "Knight 1-3, Texaco, copy."
Checking out	"Texaco 1, Knight 1-1, **checking out, resuming navigation, pushing 282**" (or "moving on to mission")	"Knight 1-1, Texaco, copy, cleared to depart." and one of: *Fortuna super te, Viking · Stay classy, Knight · Fara í víking*

Flight lead makes the initial, trail, observation and checking-out calls for the flight. **Each jet** makes its own basket and reform calls. **Shortcut:** give your amount in the initial ("...with intent to refuel, request 6.0"): Texaco clears it instead of asking.

Texaco's altitude and velocity come live from Tacview: velocity is its indicated airspeed, worked out from its track over the last hour (both legs of the racetrack, so the wind cancels). Match it on your HUD.

Words Texaco understands

Step	Any of these
Initial	15 mile initial · intent to refuel · request fuel / rejoin · checking in · inbound
Give	5.0 / five point oh · 5 thousand · 5000 pounds · full · top off
Trail	1 mile trail · in trail · astern
Observation	established port observation · establish portside · established (before a basket)
Basket	moving to port / starboard basket (or drogue, hose; left / right) · moving to the basket (Texaco gives the open one) · established ... basket · ready pre-contact (a bare "Ready pre-contact" counts when you are the only jet on the tanker)
Reform	satisfied · moving to starboard reform · refuel complete · disconnecting · established starboard reform · establish starboard side
Checking out	checking out · resuming navigation · moving on (to) mission · pushing 282 · departing · clear of the tanker
Radio check	radio / comm / com check · how copy · five by

Rules and tips

Item	Detail
Baskets	One jet per basket, two at most behind each tanker. Texaco won't clear you to a basket another jet holds; it is free again when that jet calls reform (or after 10 minutes without a call).
Moving	One jet moves at a time. Cross under and behind other aircraft. Never overtake the tanker. Don't reform the flight order in the reform area.
Departing	Stay in starboard reform until the flight is done, then a right clearing turn and/or climb; never descend.
No callsign heard	"Station calling Texaco one one, say again your callsign." Call again with your callsign. "One flight of F-18, Knight 1-1" is fine: the flight description is skipped.
Fuel won't flow?	SkyEye's calls are radio only. DCS still needs the AI menu **Ready pre-contact** before the basket will pass fuel.
No answer?	Wait 3-4 s, then repeat once. Check 252.100 / 252.300 **AM**. Report callsign, frequency and time on Discord.